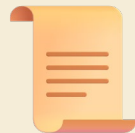


STORIES  
BEHIND  
ARTI  
FACTS



# Stories Behind Artifacts

## 文物的故事

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Every object has a past. Every artifact has a voice.  
每件文物都有過去，每件文物都在說話。

ICS Creator Academy · Summer 2026



# What Gives an Artifact Its Story? 什麼讓文物有故事？

An artifact's story comes from WHO made it, WHY, HOW it survived, and WHERE it ended up.



## WHO made it? 誰做的？

Was it made by a king, a craftsman, a child? The maker's identity changes everything about how we see the object.



## WHY was it made? 為什麼做？

Was it for worship, for beauty, for war, for everyday use? Purpose reveals what people valued most in that culture.



## HOW did it survive? 怎麼保存下來的？

Was it buried, hidden, stolen, gifted, traded? The journey of survival is often the most dramatic part of the story!



## WHERE is it now? 現在在哪裡？

Does it sit in its homeland or a foreign museum? This question causes debates about cultural heritage 文化遺產 today.



## HOW was it found? 怎麼被發現的？

Some were found by archaeologists, some by accident, some by grave robbers 盜墓賊. The discovery story is often dramatic!



## WHAT does it tell us? 告訴我們什麼？

What can we learn about daily life, beliefs, technology, or relationships between cultures from this one object?



## 羅塞塔石碑

### Rosetta Stone

Egypt EG · 196 BC  
現藏大英博物館 British Museum

🌐 Discovered: 1799, by Napoleon's soldiers in Egypt during a military campaign! 拿破崙士兵發現的！



#### Three scripts, one message 三種文字，同一段話

The stone has the same text written in Egyptian hieroglyphs 象形文字, Demotic script, AND Ancient Greek — a trilingual decree!



#### The key to Ancient Egypt 解開古埃及謎團的鑰匙

For 1,400 years no one could read hieroglyphs. The Rosetta Stone finally allowed scholars to decode them in 1822 — opening up all of ancient Egypt!



#### A trophy of war 戰利品

Napoleon's army found it in 1799. The British defeated France and took the stone in 1802. Egypt has been asking for it back ever since! 埃及一直要求歸還！



#### What does it say? 寫了什麼？

It's actually quite boring — a tax decree praising Pharaoh Ptolemy VI! But its THREE languages made it the key to unlocking all of ancient Egyptian writing.

### Found by a farmer 農民發現的



In 1974, a farmer named Yang Zhifa was digging a well when his shovel hit something hard. He had just discovered one of the greatest finds in history! 在挖井時發現的！

### An army for the afterlife 陰間軍隊



Emperor Qin Shi Huang believed he would rule in the afterlife too — so he ordered 8,000 life-sized warrior statues to protect him after death! 第一個皇帝的地下軍隊！

### Originally in full colour 原本是彩色的



Every soldier was once painted in vivid colours! But exposure to air causes the paint to fade within minutes. Scientists are racing to preserve them. 一接觸空氣就褪色！

### Most is still buried 大部分還在地下



Only 3 pits have been excavated. Archaeologists are waiting for better technology before digging more — they don't want to damage what's inside! 考古學家在等待更好的技術！



## 兵馬俑

### Terracotta Army

China CN · 210 BC  
西安 Xi'an, China

8,000+ warriors, 130 chariots, 670 horses — each soldier's face is UNIQUE! 每個士兵的臉都不一樣！



## 帕德嫩神廟雕刻

### Elgin Marbles

Greece GR · 447–438 BC  
現藏大英博物館 British Museum

 The most controversial artifacts in the world?  
Greece has been demanding them back since 1983!  
最具爭議性的文物？



#### From the Parthenon 來自帕德嫩神廟

These marble sculptures once decorated the Parthenon temple in Athens, built in 447 BC to honour goddess Athena. 雅典娜神廟的裝飾！



#### Removed by Lord Elgin 被埃爾金勳爵帶走

Between 1801-1812, British diplomat Lord Elgin removed half the sculptures and shipped them to England. Was it rescue or theft? 這是拯救還是盜竊？



#### A temple torn in two 被分開的神廟

Half the sculptures are in Athens, half in London. Greece says seeing them separated is like reading a book with half the pages torn out! 像被撕掉一半的書！



#### The debate continues 爭議持續中

The British Museum says they 'preserve' the sculptures for all humanity. Greece says they belong home. Who is right? 大英博物館說保護，希臘說要回家！



### Lost for 400 years 消失400年

After the Spanish conquest, Machu Picchu was abandoned and forgotten by the outside world. Local Peruvians knew it existed, but it was hidden in the clouds! 雲霧中的失落城市！



### 'Discovered' in 1911 1911年被'發現'

American historian Hiram Bingham was guided there by a local farmer. He claimed to 'discover' it — but local people already knew! 當地農民一直都知道！



### Engineering marvel 工程奇蹟

Built without wheels, iron tools, or mortar! The stones fit so perfectly that not even a knife blade can slide between them. 沒有輪子、鐵器或水泥！



### Still a mystery 仍是個謎

Why was it built? A royal retreat? A religious site? An astronomical observatory? Historians still debate today! 是皇家度假勝地？宗教聖地？天文台？



## 馬丘比丘

Machu Picchu

Peru PE · ~1450 AD  
秘魯 · 印加帝國遺址

🌟 UNESCO World Heritage Site 世界文化遺產 —  
visited by 1.5 million people every year! 每年150萬遊客！



## What Connects All These Stories? 這些故事有什麼共通點？

### People made them 都是人創造的



Behind every artifact is a person — with fears, hopes, creativity, and love. Artifacts connect us to real human beings across time.

### Time is their enemy 時間是它們的敵人



Every artifact fights against decay, war, theft, and neglect. The fact that they survived at all is a miracle! 能倖存下來就是奇蹟！

### They raise questions 它們引發問題



Who owns the past? Should artifacts go home? Who gets to tell the story? There are no easy answers — but these are important debates.

### They teach us 它們教導我們



Each artifact is a primary source — direct evidence of how people lived. No textbook can replace the power of an actual ancient object!



## Let's Discuss! 來討論！

1

Which artifact's story surprised you the most? Why? 哪件文物的故事最讓你驚訝？

2

Should the Elgin Marbles be returned to Greece? What about the Rosetta Stone? 文物應該歸還嗎？

3

If YOU could discover a new artifact tomorrow, what would you hope to find? 如果你能發現一件新文物，你希望找到什麼？

4

What everyday object of YOURS might be in a museum 2,000 years from now? 你現在的哪件東西2000年後會在博物館？